

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 661

By Doggett

A RESOLUTION to honor the late Bertha Mae Dees Faulkner,
posthumous recipient of the Governor's
Volunteer Stars Award.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should specially recognize those estimable citizens who have dedicated their time and energies to helping others; and

WHEREAS, each year, 1.3 million Tennessee volunteers give over 99 million hours of community service, contributing \$2.6 billion to Tennessee's economy; and

WHEREAS, these volunteers are the backbone of our communities, and by donating their time and talents to fulfill needs that would otherwise go unmet, they embody the spirit of giving; and

WHEREAS, Bertha Mae Dees Faulkner of Lawrence County was one such exemplary person; Ms. Faulkner has been posthumously honored with the Governor's Volunteer Stars Award in recognition of her laudable commitment to her community; and

WHEREAS, Bertha Mae Dees Faulkner began working with the South Central Human Resource Agency in the Head Start Program in 1973; after serving the children in her community in this capacity for thirty-three years, she began volunteering at New Prospect Elementary School; and

WHEREAS, known affectionately as "Ma Bert" by first-grade students at New Prospect, Mrs. Faulkner mentored and tutored children for nineteen years as a member of the school's Foster Grandparent Program; and

WHEREAS, during her nearly two decades at New Prospect Elementary School, "Ma Bert" was a stand-in granny for more than 370 students; her legacy of compassion and service

lives on through these individuals, as well as her three children, six grandchildren, and seven great-grandchildren; and

WHEREAS, Mrs. Faulkner was a model citizen; her commitment to helping others through volunteerism epitomized the spirit of the Volunteer State; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor the late Bertha Mae Dees Faulkner, posthumous recipient of the Governor's Volunteer Stars Award, reflecting fondly on her outstanding community leadership and her legacy of service above self.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.